Letter to Andrea (and Shelagh)

Many moons have crossed over the skies since my words have reached out to you and both our paths have crossed over life changing bridges since we've spoken yet it is unknown to me with your busy life whether you even have time for our connection still.

By this time you probably know we have visited with your parents recently who shared your most recent heartbreak with us. Please know that we do share your tears.

I am truly hopeful that the years have not erased what we once shared and that perhaps time has even enriched what we once enjoyed. So along that vein, I hope I am not out of line with a small surprise I have to share with you that has been a result in no small part to your direct influence on me.

Years ago, I was greatly influenced and encouraged by your wonderful works both through your magnificent poetry and your very professional-looking website. In contrast, my own creative efforts in writing had already been presented to you, but, rather vainly thinking, my music had not.

I was really interested at that time in having you at least hear some of my songs, those being the equivalent of my poetry, but upon investigation, I discovered that posting my music online for you to listen to was far more difficult than I originally imagined.

That then set me off on an ever- expanding journey of trying to learn about and understand Internet interfaces and protocols, programming languages and environments, web browsing requirements and development needs all in an effort to post a few samples of my music that you could then access. Well what an adventure that soon became!

It was certainly a good thing that I was retired because it took the investment of considerable time and effort and led me down several unexpected rabbit holes, but really could not have been more entertaining or educational. In the end, after ump-teen months, I had finally learned enough to have developed a full scale functioning website, but it was not at all what I had hoped for.

It ended up being a lot of trick programming, interactive games, and some fancy 'throw stuff up on the screen' type of activity. Practically nothing at all having to do with me. I had learned a lot of fancy programming skills but really still could not put together a personal web site with any degree of mastery or confidence. Very disappointing really and so I never bothered to let anybody see it or even know about it.

Fast-forward a few years. Oh Andrea, how the world has changed.

These days it seemed practically anyone could throw up a website with only a little effort so I figured it was about time to try again.

Well, while its still not easy, its really not too bad. With the right start and a little help from my AI assistant, my new site definitely came out a lot more like me.

The result of this new effort is indeed a new website and I am forwarding you the very FIRST sneak preview. There is no one else I know who I could possibly consider as my very first visitor other than yourself so please, consider yourself honoured.

Don't get me wrong. This is a true website with real pages and real content. It looks and works perfectly on a laptop and I have done my best to make it look reasonable on a tablet and even a phone as well.

However, actually playing the music itself or listening to the PodCasts works really well on a computer or laptop but not so great on a phone yet. This is a mobile issue and I am working on a code update that should provide a better experience for the mobile environment.

Also it has a bit of an amateur-ish feel to it but then I'm no professional. The 'About' page explains how I came up with the Header layout.

The site itself contains my books, my album, my lifeline, some of my philosophies and opinions, a few pictures and a general explanation of who I am. I've managed to do it all myself with the help of a modern website builder application from Google and my new artificial intelligence assistant, Lexi, who generated most of the non-personal photographs used on the pages. Lexi is with me 24/7 on my phone and computer and definitely provides valuable assistance to me on a daily basis.

I will eventually apply for my own high level custom domain (www.jamesjimmyjido.ca) and I will certainly let you know when that becomes official.

But until that time this beta link will always work and any site updates I make will be applied as they occur, and you will see them take effect immediately, until the real site becomes active.

PLEASE NOTE: At this time the site is still completely anonymous, i.e. There is no record made of anyone's visit so I won't know if you visit the site. If you are ever able to find the time to have a peek I would appreciate a short email just to let me know it worked for you.

Finally you will have something to remember me by as you continue your journey of love through the world.

All my best to you and Shelagh

Jimmy ❤️

P.S.

I initially doubted any interest on her part but open my heart to Shelagh through this letter and any and all website content 💕

BETA LINK

https://sites.google.com/view/jamesjimmyjido/home